The Obama administration has consistently displayed hostility to Israel, bullying it into making potentially lethal security compromises with the Palestinian Authority and blaming it falsely for stalling the Middle East peace process. In the process, the United States blatantly ignores and sanitises the persistent bellicosity towards Israel expressed by Mahmoud Abbas and the egregious incitement to hatred and violence against Israelis and Jews promulgated by the Palestinian Authority.

In addition, Obama has soft-pedalled on Iran, ignoring the status the United States itself conferred upon the Islamic regime as the world's principal state backer of terrorism and treating it instead as a credible negotiating partner over its nuclear program—and even as an ally in fighting Islamic State in Iraq (which reliable reports credit it with having helped establish in the first place). The result is that the Iranian regime has been empowered in the region to spread its destabilising and terrorist activities, steadily moving towards achieving nuclear bomb breakout capability and reinforcing its grip on Iran's terrorised citizens whose ability to rise up and overthrow the regime has thus been significantly hampered.

Precisely what impels President Obama to behave in this way is a question for another occasion. What is clear, however, is that he wants to even up the balance between the west and the rest to make up for the historic harm he believes has been done by America to the developing world. Empowering America's enemies therefore appears to represent what he considers to be fair.

Auto-immune disease disables and even kills human beings by confusing the body's enemy organisms with its friends, causing the body to embrace the former while attacking the latter. In attacking Israel and abandoning its own Arab allies while empowering its enemies, the west has engaged in a political form of auto-immune disease.

So how should one explain such apparently lethal perversity? Much derives from the fact that, since World War II, the west's cultural and political establishment has effectively turned against itself.

We can see this in the trajectory of human rights doctrine. Israel has the most moral military force in the world, and its society is arguably the most tightly regulated by human rights law. So it is astonishing that Israel should find itself characterised as on the wrong side of this issue—demonised by human rights NGOs, damned by the International Court of Justice, and vilified in Britain and Europe as war criminals. This becomes all too comprehensible, however, given that human rights in general have been turned into a weapon of war, not just against Israel but in the cultural

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